

example of the success of our policies. The world today sees India as the incubator of innovation.

Not only have global experts appreciated India's use of digital public infrastructure, but I also sense a lot of interest in them during my meetings with world leaders.

India's digital public infrastructure has a diverse stack of products which find utility in both the Global South and the developed world. Many countries are interested in learning from our experience, and we have successfully initiated co-operation with at least a dozen countries.

We are working with G20 countries to accelerate global development by leveraging technology, particularly promoting the concept of digital public goods through a common approach to digital public infrastructure. And this has been deeply appreciated by the G20 membership at large.

We are confident that the growing popularity of India's digital public infrastructure will go a long way in accelerating global financial inclusion and ease of living.

44 | Q: There has been discussion around using the G20 platform for helping build a global start-up ecosystem. How does your government hope to move forward in this regard?

A: If we look at history, there had been an era of incremental growth for quite some time. But today, things have changed. From an era of incremental change, we have gone to the era of disruptive innovations. The magnitude of change that was seen in 100 years earlier, happens in just 10 years now! This means that the governments and society have to be ready to catch up with the rapid changes.

If we look at India's experience, we not only understood the potential of start-ups, but also provided them with a launch pad.

We engaged the youth with multiple opportunities. We started Atal Innovation Mission and Atal Tinkering Labs. Today, there are 10,000 Atal Tinkering Labs in which 75 lakh students have worked on lakhs of innovation projects. We have set up incubation centres and held a large number of hackathons. We have also held hackathons in partnership with various countries. This

led to the development of a mindset of 'problem solving'.

All these interventions have led to the exponential emergence of start-ups and these start-ups are bringing about disruptive change.

Today, India has around a hundred thousand start-ups and 100 unicorns. A lot of experts see India as the hub of start-ups. When this is our basic governance philosophy, it is natural that we want to take this momentum globally.

Building on our success and recognising the importance of start-ups globally, India, during its G20 leadership, made a significant move by establishing the Startup20 Engagement Group. This is the first of its kind initiative under the G20. This grouping is acting as the voice of the global start-up ecosystem bringing together varied stakeholders on a common platform.

It aspires to create a global narrative for supporting start-ups and enabling synergies between start-ups, corporates, investors, innovation agencies and other key ecosystem stakeholders.

We are positive that they will be able to take concrete steps in areas like capacity building, identification of funding gaps, enhancement of employment opportunities, achievement of SDG targets, and growth of an inclusive ecosystem.

The meetings of this new Engagement Group have generated enormous interest and we hope that this will establish itself as a key pillar of the G20 process.

“It is the duty of each country to guard itself from financial indiscipline but at the same time there are forces that have sought to take undue advantage by catalysing debt crises”

Q: The IMF has said India is the fastest growing economy in the world with an expected growth of 6.1 per cent this fiscal. Do you expect the economy to do better than anticipated this fiscal given that most macroeconomic indicators remain robust and point towards revived demand?

A: The experience of the last few years suggests that India has performed better than predicted. This is our track record.

Today, we are growing faster than most countries and our people deserve credit for it. Now, when we aspire to grow even faster, our people have a big responsibility. Our national character will play a big role as we take the next leap of growth. Just like the Swadeshi Andolan gave great strength to our freedom